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Virginia Board of Education, Special Committee on Standards of Accreditation, Tuesday, April 20, 2021

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- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LVpvdfY9L9w
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

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[00:00:26] - Thanks, Kevin. - I'm good to go. - Thanks.

[00:00:52] Hi, Leslie. - Emily, thanks for color coordinating with me. - Yeah. Hi, Dr. Paxton. - Hello again, how are you? - Good, just to let you and everyone else know, I have this screen share up.

[00:01:10] We are live on YouTube. And once we get closer to start time here, just in a couple of minutes, I'll pull it down so we can actually see each other. But just wanna make sure folks know which meeting this is. - Sounds good.

[00:01:24] lot this month. Let's see. I still think we're waiting on a few more folks. I'm going to go

[00:03:41] ahead and stop the screen share so that we can actually see, try to see everybody. Looks like we

[00:04:24] are just waiting on Mrs. Davis Vaught and then we will be ready to get going here in just a couple

[00:04:33] minutes. Let's see. So I know, Dr. Bexon, I know that Dr. Wilson is not able to join us, at least

[00:06:22] for the start but i have not heard from mrs davis fought about not being able to join um susan this may be a question for you i think this is a four four committee or four person committee if we have

two members are we still able to get started or do we need to wait for mrs davis fought to join how many members are on the committee i didn't hear i was having trouble - Four, we have four members on the committee.

[00:06:52] - Okay, so we need a quorum of three, so. - Of three, okay. - Do we need a quorum, Susan, though, to start or to vote? - Oh, to vote, to vote, but I thought that's what you said. - No, I think we can start the meeting without voting on anything. - As long as you don't vote.

[00:07:09] - We don't have anything to vote on today. So I think we are good to go, Dr. Fexton. - We cannot adopt the minutes, but other than that, we can move forward. - Yeah, no votes. - Okay, great. So we'll just go ahead and get started, if that's okay, Emily.

[00:07:26] - Totally. - Okay, good, good afternoon. Thank you everybody for joining us today for a meeting of the special committee to review the standards of accreditation. Hopefully you guys have been taking full advantage of this beautiful weather we've been receiving over the past week.

[00:07:43] We had a little bit of rain, I know, in my area yesterday, but aside from that, I feel a little spoiled. I think President Gecker mentioned it in our executive meeting, how it'd be nice to go sit outside and hold this meeting outside. But anyways, I'm hoping you guys are taking advantage of how beautiful it is and sitting here staring at it out of the corner of my eye, being a little envious.

[00:08:04] But so we're meeting today rather than on our usual Wednesday afternoon to allow the full board to meet for our annual retreat tomorrow. I will note that the board does plan to meet back in person starting in June and we will be releasing more details those in-person meetings as we get closer to those dates. During today's committee meeting, we will continue moving forward with our committee work plan based off of our November 2020 discussions. So first up, we will receive a presentation from the VDOE staff on student discipline and disproportionality. And this presentation will provide information about

[00:08:43] VDOE's current and future measurement strategy for discipline disproportionality. Following that presentation we will hear from dr leslie sale on the potential changes to graduation requirements and have a discussion on possible options for consolidating the standard and advanced studies diplomas i know the committee has been looking forward to both these topics and are likely to be eager to engage uh at the end of the meeting i am going to do a kind of a summarizing uh review of all of the topics that the committee initially identified of having a level of interest and i'll

[00:09:20] And I'll go ahead and plant the seed now that I am going to be looking for any kind of feedback of following these presentations, you know, what additional information we might need to still consider before we move towards making some final recommendations, if any, come later this summer.

[00:09:38] So just to confirm before I move on to introducing our first speaker, just want to confirm that we do not have Ms. Davis Vaught to do a motion to approve minutes. Dr. Fexton. We just joined. Okay. Great.

[00:09:54] Awesome. So, that being said, I would like to ask if the committee members have had a chance to review the minutes from the March 17, 2021 committee meeting? Yes. And if so, can I get a motion to approve or amend the minutes?

[00:10:13] So, move to approve the minutes. Thank you, Dr. Garan. Is there a second? Second. Second, ma'am. Thank you, Ms. Davis-Thought. and we'll do this by roll call. Ms. Davis-Vaught, Dr. Duran. Aye. And

the chair votes aye. Okay, so first up on the agenda is the presentation on discipline disproportionality. Our presenters today are Dr. Jennifer Pivarenna, director of research, Brittany Kennard, education data

[00:10:48] specialist, Rebecca Kahila, I apologize if I did not get that correct, a school safety and Discipline Specialist, and Julie Malik, Director of Accountability. Dr. Jen, I'll turn it over to you to get us started. Great. Thanks so much, Dr. Pexton. Good afternoon, Dr. Pexton, members of the committee, Dr. Lane. I'm pleased to kick off our presentation this afternoon. We'd like to provide you with information on the department's current and planned use of data on discipline disproportionality, and we thought this information would be useful to you as you consider recommendations that you

[00:11:26] you received last month from the African-American Superintendents Advisory Council on discipline disproportionality. And I believe Emily is going to bring up the slides. Yeah, Jen, I'm trying. I'm not sure where all the presentations are pulled up, but they're not letting me pull them up. So okay i can keep talking if you'd like i can i can pinch hit i think um yeah julie if you can let me try one more time i'm like i said i have everything pulled up and

[00:12:05] nothing is showing for me to actually share um so julie if you're able to that would get us started and let me figure out what the issue is all right let's see if i can make that happen hang on just All right. Who is that?

[00:12:31] Thank you, Julie. I bet. You can go ahead to the second slide for me. That'd be great. All right. So as you can see from the offices that are listed here on the slide, there are many pieces of the department that are engaged in the work on discipline disproportionality.

[00:12:50] And the charge of this working group in particular is to develop and implement a measurement strategy that guides the department's reporting of exclusionary discipline and discipline disproportionality. The goal of any measurement strategy is really to speak with one voice on this issue.

[00:13:09] So as you will see from the presentation today, there are several strategies that we are currently using to measure discipline disproportionality. And there are several use cases that we'll also review of that data. And we do have a new data collection being implemented next year. So we want to take an opportunity through this working group to address head-on any confusion around the definition or calculation of discipline disproportionality and be consistent in our messaging about this critical topic.

[00:13:36] So next slide. To that end for today's presentation today, I will define a couple of terms, go through some common calculations with you, and then describe a few ways that we already report on and use discipline disproportionality.

[00:13:55] Then I'm going to turn it over to my colleagues Brittany Kennard and Rebecca Kahila to talk specifically about the very near-term changes to our data collection that will impact how we talk about and report on discipline disproportionality. And then following that, Julie Malik, our pinch hitter for today, will talk about future considerations for accountability in Virginia as well.

[00:14:19] So next slide. So that we start with the same understanding, I do want to take a moment to define exclusionary Discipline and Discipline Disproportionality as separate concepts. So, exclusionary discipline includes any type of school disciplinary action that removes or excludes a student from their usual education setting. And when you see this reported, you're often hearing about out-of-school suspensions and expulsions, which are examples of exclusionary discipline. But those examples are really just the tip of the iceberg when it comes to exclusionary discipline. Exclusionary discipline

[00:14:57] can often include but is less consistently reported things like removal from class, alternative placements, and even disciplinary sanctions where instructional services are offered. So exclusionary discipline is a pretty wide umbrella even though we often see just suspensions or expulsions most commonly reported for this category. Next slide.

[00:15:21] So you're probably familiar with the phrase school to prison pipeline that's often used when discussing exclusionary discipline and you may have heard anecdotes for example a student who is suspended from school they have sort of nothing better to do with their day so they end up getting into some kind of trouble and so while that does certainly happen in some cases the research suggests that the pathway from exclusionary discipline to juvenile justice involvement is not a direct line but really something that is mediated by this sort of growing uh culminating

[00:15:57] sense of disengagement from school so if you picture a snowball sort of rolling down a hill here the snowball starts to form around this cycle that you see on the left hand side of your screen of certain students not feeling welcome or not feeling comfortable in school they may display behaviors that are not consistent with being a good student i put that in quotes and then they end up being punished or excluded from the classroom which creates this general sense of disengagement this idea that school is not for them and so over time that disengagement begins to display itself through poor achievement through absenteeism through the risk of dropping out

[00:16:37] puts them at greater risk of not graduating and even greater risk of involvement in the juvenile justice system so when you think about this cycle and this context it's a bit easier to see how even removing a student from class repeatedly can potentially aggravate some of these negative effects. Next slide. So discipline disproportionality is when any group's representation in a particular category for a particular outcome exceeds expectations for that group.

[00:17:10] It's really an indication that something is off balance. And you can see an example of disproportionality in Virginia, and you've seen this statistic before as well. Black students comprise about 22% of our total student enrollment but 54% of all students suspended. So again this idea that something is out of balance here and we generally think of disproportionality as a symptom of a larger problem. So next slide. So this one's a bit busy but I want to talk through just briefly

[00:17:44] some of the research that indicates what factors contribute to disproportionality and two factors that are often cited as contributing that actually do not contribute to disproportionality. So focusing on the left-hand side of the model there, so if disproportionality exists in any setting, there are generally four stones, if you will, that you would overturn to get at some of the root causes of that disproportionality. And that's not to indicate that there's one single solution or one single cause to disproportionality. There's a lot of overlapping context here.

[00:18:17] but generally when we're thinking about policies we're primarily thinking about student discipline or student code of conduct policies that are created with good intentions but can inadvertently have an impact on certain groups of students zero tolerance policies are a good example of this they've been shown to increase the rate of black students suspended they were very popular at one time they are now fading out of popularity and student code of conducts are moving away of that in favor of other alternative policies and a little bit later in our presentation rebecca and brittany are actually going to talk to you about the board's model guidance that you issued in

[00:18:56] january of 2019 around this topic specifically when we're thinking about processes we're talking about the implementation of policies so are those policies being implemented differentially in different student groups or are there alternative strategies in place that provide supports instead of punishment. When we're thinking about places, I think the context, particularly in Virginia, is that schools are becoming increasingly more isolated by race and poverty. And so school segregation is often associated with unequal resources. And schools where the majority of

[00:19:32] students are students of color or there is a high concentration of poverty, those schools may have fewer resources for preventative measures. They may have fewer resources for alternatives to suspensions, and so we often see high rates of discipline and discipline disproportionality occurring in those settings. And when it comes to people, we're really talking about biases, both explicit and implicit, where we want to modify the behavior of adults in the building and also create a diverse workforce, which is a priority of this board. So it's just as important to rule out factors that do not explain disproportionality based on the research,

[00:20:10] and that's sort of the right side of this slide. So there is unfortunately a common assumption that black students on the whole behave worse than their peers so but research would suggest that even for the same incident the same behavior in the same school black students are still more likely to be suspended for that same incident that same behavior than their white peers and the second piece of this is poverty so while poverty is is absolutely important to think about the context of place and what concentrated poverty in particular the impact that has on communities and

[00:20:48] families multiple studies suggest that race is consistently a bigger predictor of discipline disproportionality than poverty so when you compare the outcomes the disciplinary outcomes of poor black students to poor white students you still find that black students are more likely to be suspended in those settings so next slide i do want to make a couple of points about calculating disproportionality. And we're going to get into, we're going to dive a little bit deep in this and then we're going to come up a little bit for air and look at some specific use cases. So at the

[00:21:25] department, we commonly use relative risk to calculate disproportionality, particularly when our goal is to identify an area or a building or a division of concern. This is not the only way to measure disproportionality, however. And so part of our process as the working group that I mentioned earlier is to really evaluate our measurement options to determine what methodology not only accurately reflects disproportionality but also can be clearly communicated to the public. So in the moment I'm going to walk through an example for you of relative risk but I do just want to

[00:22:02] state that the calculation in general divides the likelihood of an outcome or the risk of an outcome for one group by the risk of that outcome for another group. One common misconception about disproportionality is that students who have repeated events so students who have multiple suspensions can contribute to disproportionality that is not true with the the way that we calculate it here because in these calculations a student only counts once so even if they're suspended two or three or four times and these calculations when we're thinking about

[00:22:36] disproportionality that student is only counting once as a student suspended and we're interpreting relative risk and we'll get into this an example on the next slide it's really looking at the strength of the relationship between the outcome and the group at risk for that outcome so next slide okay

so here's a pretty straightforward example i think it sort of helps to make it a little concrete when we talk about relative risk in particular and so in your numerator you have

[00:23:13] the number of black students suspended in this case divided by the total number of black students that could be in a school it could be in a division sort of whatever unit you want to to make it and what you do is you divide that by the number of non-black students suspended and divided by the number of non-black students so that's essentially the risk of a black student being suspended divided by the risk of a non-black student being suspended and so we've made up some arbitrary numbers here but if you do the math you get a relative risk of 3.07 and so we would interpret

[00:23:48] that by saying Black students in this school or in this division are 3.3 times around. Three times as likely to be suspended compared to non-Black students. Next slide. So we do want to walk you through a couple of examples of the way that the department uses that data and reports on discipline disproportionality. And again, you're going to see some variation in the measurement here, and that's something that we're still evaluating, but there are multiple ways to measure disproportionality and depending on your purpose for the measurement and what you're trying to

[00:24:25] achieve that may vary some so next slide julie you can go to the next slide we'll go through each of these thanks okay so starting with special education so for students with disabilities the feds require states to determine if disproportionality is occurring in a number of ways including as i've noted here in red for disciplinary actions so if a division is identified for discipline disproportionality among students with disabilities the fed the feds then require that school divisions set aside a proportion of their special education funds for additional

[00:25:01] services next slide the federal requirements and the federal guidance say that the methodology that we use in this case has to be reasonable and so it's pretty broad and it's really up to the states to decide. For Virginia, we consulted with our stakeholders, and we do use a relative risk, as I showed before, for this calculation. And the threshold was also selected in part based on feedback from our stakeholders, so that divisions that have a relative risk of 3.0 or greater for

[00:25:37] three consecutive years would be identified under these rules and would be required to set aside a part of their funds to address this particular issue. I do want to mention that we do have a set of rules in place here to consider group size because relative risk can be influenced by the overall demographics of schools and divisions.

[00:26:00] So depending on how the population is distributed, there are some concerns there with just how accurate relative risk can be. And so we take that into consideration for this. The data source for this is the Discipline, Crime, and Violence Collection.

[00:26:16] That is a collection that through this school year was our primary source of statewide information on school discipline. And my colleagues, Rebecca and Brittany, are gonna talk about how we're transitioning away from the Discipline, Crime, and Violence Collection, not only how it's different, but also why we are moving in that direction.

[00:26:37] Next slide. So discipline data is also central to our Virginia tiered systems of support. So this uses a framework that encourages data-informed decision-making for divisions and for schools to tier supports for students.

[00:26:55] So at the state level, discipline data are often used to measure project goals and outcomes. And at the division level, the data are used to develop supports and to identify students in areas of need specifically.

[00:27:10] Next slide. So in this use case, discipline data that's used by the Virginia tiered systems of support goes beyond just suspensions to also examine office discipline referrals. So office discipline referrals are sort of the below the waterline part of the iceberg that we often don't talk about when it comes to exclusionary discipline because it's not consistently reported statewide, but it could be a key indicator, particularly of disproportionality.

[00:27:42] So instead of using the statewide collection, the Virginia tiered systems of support relies more on schools and divisions provide detailed data on disciplinary actions so that they can work more closely with those school divisions in response to the data that's available next slide so just want to reiterate here that vtss in particular our virginia tiered systems of support uses discipline data in multiple ways from high level annual reporting to supporting specific school division teams to programmatic

[00:28:18] decisions at the state level it's really embedded within this model of supporting and tiering supports for students next slide i think may be of interest to you as well is where we report this data publicly and how it is reported so we have several public reporting tools that provide data based on again that statewide discipline crime and violence data collection so one of those is the safe schools information report so this allows users to pull suppressed data in an analyzable

[00:28:53] format directly from our website. We also have on the school quality profiles two visualizations on discipline data, and I have snapshots of both of those on the next two slides, so we'll go through those specifically. Julie, next slide. Okay, so this is a snapshot of one of the visualizations on the learning climate tab of the school quality profiles. So the SOA currently requires public reporting of incidents of crime and violence, and so this is the statewide

[00:29:25] incident count for those select offenses. And then next slide. So again, on the learning climate tab, we do also report for suspensions, as you see here, but also for expulsions, the percent of student population compared to the percent of suspensions. So this is one of the different ways that we reflect disproportionality. So you could glean from this visualization, the statistic I presented earlier about Black students comprising 22% of the student population, that's on the left,

[00:29:59] but 54% of suspensions, and that's on the right. So with our new data collection, which we are going to talk about in just a moment, we will have another opportunity to evaluate the metrics that are featured on the SQPs and determine where there could be some update. Next slide.

[00:30:18] And the last use case that I wanted to talk to you about is a quarterly research bulletin that we put out back in February 2019 that was focused on discipline disproportionality. And I've pulled from that just a couple of snapshots of some of the mapping that we did for discipline disproportionality.

[00:30:38] And you can see here, again, we're focusing on a relative risk. That was a way for us to categorize the disproportionality that's happening across school divisions. And so this map here compares the risk of suspension for Black students compared to non-Black students.

[00:30:55] very similar to the example that I walked you through a couple of slides ago and what you can see here is that 16 divisions in our state have a relative risk of 3.0 or greater meaning students in that division black students in that division have a higher risk of being suspended and I think what you can

take from this map is that disproportionality is a statewide issue and And it is something that certainly needs more attention and needs to be addressed.

[00:31:25] And this is really, again, just the sort of tip of the iceberg, if you will. Julie, if you could move to the next slide. If we even look one layer deeper than the map that I just showed you, and just look at gender, and I apologize for the small type here, but what you can see here in the top left is that we have 12 divisions in the state that have a high relative risk for black male suspensions, but 41 divisions in the state that have a relative risk, a high relative risk for black female suspension.

[00:31:59] So even just sort of taking this one level deeper and starting to disaggregate the data, you see some disproportionality, even when it comes to gender as well, where our black female students in particular are at much greater risk of suspension.

[00:32:15] Next slide. And so with that, I'm going to turn it over to Brittany Kennard and Rebecca Kahila to talk through the framework and the details of our new data collection, the Student Behavior and Administrative Response collection.

[00:32:35] - Thank you, Jennifer, Dr. Lane and members of the board. If we could go to the next slide, please. So the SBAR as it's come to be known, Student Behavior and Administrative Response Data Collection will inform practice to improve opportunities and outcomes for students.

[00:32:56] It is based on the document that Jennifer referenced earlier, which is the model guidance for positive and preventative code of student conduct policy. The model guidance, which was approved by the board in January of 2019 has shifted the mindset of school leaders to understand that student behavior is communication and that adult responses to student behavior are opportunities to meet student needs and improve the outcomes for all students.

[00:33:28] And the SBAR data collection is designed and intended to support that mindset shift with valuable data. It will measure not only what the student behaviors are, it will also measure the adult practices for responding to those behaviors.

[00:33:46] The SBAR data will provide school leaders with information to understand what kinds of discipline sanctions, academic supports, behavioral interventions are working to help students stay in school and on track to graduate they'll also be able to identify those that are not working because what we measure can inform change it's very important that we start to measure more than just disciplinary exclusions DCV told us about those exclusions and and highlighted that we have a disparity in the

[00:34:21] use of exclusionary discipline but we missed a lot of other data about what we were doing to help students and how schools were responding in ways to keep students in school to help them change behavior and so SBAR is intended to refocus and change that lens we could go to the next slide please so just to give you sort of a comparison between the two data sets discipline crime and violence just from the title alone you can tell that it's very heavily relies on describing student

[00:35:01] behavior using a lot of times Virginia code Virginia criminal code focused on crimes on punishment it's a record of exclusions when we suspend or expel students the student behavior and administrative response data collection is intended to take a more restorative approach it will require administrators to look at student behavior and describe that behavior in ways that are not related to crime and then to ask the question what harm was caused by the behavior

[00:35:36] so that an intervention can be planned for that student to change the behavior so students can be included in the school so it's more a record of responses and various responses to student behavior next slide please so jennifer showed you a little while ago the report on the sqp about all of the different kinds of behaviors behaviors against staff against students weapons possessions

[00:36:13] sbar will collect data in these categories and administrators will use these categories to make decisions around what interventions are most appropriate for students because these behavior categories can inform also improving school climate so for example a school shows that they have a lot of behaviors in category a behaviors that impede academic progress they may want to spend some time with their staff working on classroom management whereas if they

[00:36:48] have a lot of behaviors show up in the category C or relationship behaviors they may want to focus more on some explicit instruction and how to get along and how to work with others and things related to those social emotional learning skills so it's very important that we are going to be able to look at data in terms of the impact student behavior has on the schools and that we're going to be able to focus more on school improvement using this kind of data. Next slide, please.

[00:37:24] Brittany is going to talk to you about the change in the response lens and what we're going to look at in terms of responses to student behavior. Thank you, Rebecca. So once an administrator identifies the behavior, they can then choose a response for that behavior based on these three categories but are not limited to just one the categories are discipline sanctions behavioral interventions and instructional support the discipline sanctions collected are no longer just exclusions we include many alternatives to suspensions and can now capture those when we

[00:37:59] couldn't before those include things like loss of privilege or assigned community service the behavioral interventions will show us what a school is doing to support the student such as making a referral to support teams or a counseling service so these are things that divisions already have in place but now we're able to capture and collect that data with the additional collection of the instructional support we can now see what supports are put in place to maintain academic progress for students like a change in placement for a student with an iep or an additional instructional service provided this data allows us to look at the opportunities we provide for

[00:38:39] students through these behavioral interventions and academic supports. We will then be able to measure the effectiveness of alternatives to suspension, including alternative education placements. We can then begin to measure the efficacy of those responses and we'll have real data to show us if those responses and supports are working to change the outcome of that student behavior. This allows us to study equity and responses beyond just exclusionary discipline and view equity through access to support next slide please so a change in the data collection

[00:39:17] results in the change in public reporting we'll be replacing the safe schools information report with a query capability it's called a build a table tool much like what we use now for membership on the video website we also plan to develop a division equity report which divisions can use to analyze their data and we're in discussions on what this will look like on the school quality profiles. Next slide please. So now the real focus is on calculating discipline disproportionality. With the implementation of SBAR, VDOE will be able to focus on informing

[00:39:56] practices through more student-based data and using these discipline sanctions, standardize the definitions and calculations, and create consistency in communication and definition. thank you okay

thank you Brittany and Rebecca um now and Jen I'm I'm going to take us now into some considerations for accountability we think that um we know this is kind of how this discussion

[00:40:33] got spurred and this this group got together to really understand what has been happening for quite some time and the plans moving forward and how all this may or may not fit together so Just as you recall, last month, the African American Superintendent's Advisory Council presented a recommendation to include discipline disproportionality as an indicator in the state's accountability system. In addition to this, as we did some research, we noted that in 2019, the Mid-Atlantic Comprehensive Center released a policy brief and also recommended that

[00:41:11] disproportionality in school discipline could be integrated in the state accountability systems it's very important however that within that brief they also recommended a few other things which have been discussed today such as to build the capacity of districts and schools to analyze and use school discipline data effectively and i think you heard through the presentation with Rebecca and Brittany we are on that path also they it's also very important that they recommended that we expand states collection reporting and use of discipline data beyond the

[00:41:48] previous requirements so we have definitely made a leap in that regard so those recommendations are all lumped together so once we have moved forward very well with changing some of the data collection so just wanted to acknowledge that in this reference so as you have seen this before there's multiple levels of accountability so truly analyzing at what point this data would

[00:42:23] be most effective to create change and improvement is part of the larger discussion that we'll have in the future but as be part of our research video we did reach out to the education commission of the states to determine what accountability models were across the nation that included discipline disproportionality specifically and their research returned to us that four states use discipline data in their federal accountability models and it's important to note that the

[00:42:56] education commission really only looks at the federal models just as a side note so there are actually four states that use discipline data and accountability models but it's important to note that they are not discipline disproportionality measures they are in reference to suspensions and exclusions and I think it's important to note some of those other discipline measures that Brittany spoke of so it's not just about suspensions and expulsions as we move forward so let's just

[00:43:33] take a look at those four just so that you have an idea of what is is currently taking place across the nation um two of the states iowa and rhode island they use discipline and it's a little bit of a different system than what virginia uses where they they take a bunch of measures and they aggregate it and crunch some numbers and weight it appropriately and the end result is some some bottom line number which then usually translates to like an a through f grade or a star system

[00:44:06] so again iowa focuses on suspensions and expulsions as a as a group and it's actually combined with other measures to to um again it gets weighed into the accountability model for that final rating rhode island looks at number of out-of-school suspensions per 100 students which is another measure another way to look at discipline and again it's been rolled into their overall star rating the two states that are more similar to Virginia in that they have

[00:44:44] different indi the accountability model is they have different indicators and within those indicators they assign performance levels so California looks at students suspended for how many percent

of students aggregate that were suspended for one full day or more and then they place it on a performance level and then they report out in that manner. West Virginia kind of has the flip they actually evaluate students that receive zero out of school suspensions within a school year and then again assign a performance level off of that data but once again

[00:45:21] none of these focus on discipline disproportionality which i believe has been the input from our various stakeholders as what we believe is is a true and a perhaps a more appropriate measure as we move forward with this work and we look forward to to moving forward as such i'm now going to pause and see if there are any questions from the group and i'm going to stop sharing so that we can see

[00:45:58] everyone's face there it is all right great thank you very much for that that presentation um so again to to julie's point are there any questions or comments from committee or board members uh mr swan yes thank you so much for the presentation um just had a question about the performance levels when um society looks at that is it specified that the performance level is just

[00:46:31] based off of the discipline or does it also include the academics in that once it is projected? It depends on the model. The California and the West Virginia is similar to our accreditation system where that indicator has a performance level and some of those might also fold in other school quality such as a survey or whatnot. Each state is actually a bit different and then

[00:47:04] the other two states Iowa and Rhode Island um it is the the final performance level as we know it or as we think of it is actually combined in with all of the indicators for a final answer or a final determination so it it the the accountability models range um dramatically from state to state thank you so much you're welcome Ms. Davis-Bott thank you very much for your presentation i i appreciate everything that you put into this is very timely and i applaud your

[00:47:41] efforts for your research and i specifically enjoyed how you would address the disproportionality but i'm curious if the s bar had if there were any conversations around or discussions around family connections because at the elementary school level and i go back to what miss walker has said in many presentations about what are the inputs what are what is it that we're doing and i know that in my corner of the world the effort to get to the core problem with each of

[00:48:16] our children is sometimes a little bit beyond what the child is actually can actually be held accountable for during the school day it's a function of what's going on at home the the training the modeling and how they handle situations at home so have there been any conversations about how the inputs of the school system could be evaluated the extent that school systems and teachers and principals and divisions go to in order to modify behavior i can i can try

[00:48:55] to answer that question for you a lot of the things that we'll be collecting in terms of behavioral interventions include things like parent contact parent conferencing use of community resources like community service board counselors student intervention teams and those kinds of responses so that on the doe website there is an s bar page that lists all of these different types of interventions that school divisions will be able to report to us and they will be able then

[00:49:30] to measure their own success or their own use of those contacts with families and resources so that is a part of that data collection thank you rebecca okay uh dr mann i believe you have a question as well thanks so much dr pexton and thanks so much for the presentation it was very informative um i wondered um about the methodology that's being used to measure disproportionality

[00:50:10] and this new way of understanding the behavior lens opportunity lens this this new framework and i'm wondering does the relative uh disproportionality methodology change as a result of this new framework for looking at a different data set to i i think i i didn't clearly understand that and then i just wondered when you look at the way you're measuring disproportionality um relative disproportionality is that pretty common across that common i got to

[00:50:50] use that in quotes when i just heard you say only four states even look at discipline from a federal accountability perspective so i was curious to what extent the the method reflects the way many other um states try to measure and wrap their arms around this and then again does that methodology change with the new ways in which you're talking about looking at behavior and opportunity so if you could just clarify those things that would be terrific sure thanks thanks for the question

[00:51:29] dr man i'll i'll attempt a clarification and then ask my colleagues to jump in if i mess this up but um i think you know to your first question about does the methodology change with our new collection i think the methodology that we choose to to to determine disproportionality whether it's relative risk or something else may stay consistent but what's going to to change is how we feed into that or what sort of measures feed into that disproportionality the advantage that the s bar gives us particularly when we think about disproportionality is that it's going to

[00:52:04] capture more behaviors that lead to exclusionary discipline than what we have now. So primarily, what we use now is suspensions and expulsions. That's what we get statewide. But the SBAR collection will also give us removals from class. It will give us alternatives to suspension, even if they include instructional services. And it gives us some other options there that we know school divisions are using when it comes to exclusionary discipline, but we don't have a way to capture them now so when we think about the differences there and the transition that we're going to make

[00:52:39] between the collections i would say that our definition of discipline disproportionality is going to broaden significantly but i think the way we calculate it may be very similar i think your other point about you know is relative risk common is this sort of the right approach there's actually quite a bit of debate on this i think you'll find that most states are reporting either rates of suspension or they're reporting a similar statistic to what we use on the school quality profile which is a comparison between sort of the percent of the population and

[00:53:14] the percent of students that are suspended and that's primarily because those are relatively easy things for especially a public audience to understand when you start talking about relative risk like the translation of that is very tricky and can be i think a little more difficult to describe and for folks to understand so there are multiple ways that we could think about this whether we want to continue to move down the path of sort of relative risk there's also a methodology looking at the gap in discipline between student groups so that's maybe something that we also try

[00:53:49] and pursue i think there are probably uh sort of a four or five options for us here but i would say relative risk is not necessarily the most common i think what we we typically see at least from a state reporting perspective are either rates of suspension or a comparison between the suspensions and student populations and if that didn't answer your questions let me know no that's very helpful just one quick follow-up and then i'll i'll yield to others i see other hands up um when i looked at

[00:54:20] the category on the s bar of the behaviors not the opportunities are you envisioning that there's going to be guidance on they they seemed very qualitative like open to judgment in terms of how you think

about what makes sense in one box versus another and i was just curious about that and and and thank you your your response did help me on the first two questions i appreciate it yeah absolutely and so for the sfar collection and britney please jump in if i don't get this quite right i think what we presented to you was probably the highest level of information that we

[00:54:58] could. And so underneath each of those buckets are specific codes that we're asking school divisions to report to us where those behaviors have been defined. And so what we know based on the discipline, crime and violence collection is there was a whole lot of subjectivity in terms of what school divisions were reporting where. And we've tried to clean that up tremendously in terms of SBAR being very specific, much more specific about the behaviors we're looking for. And Brittany and her team have also been providing a great deal of training to school divisions as well and webinars on this and addressing those questions in advance we actually had a bit of

[00:55:35] a benefit here if you can call it that where were you anticipating as far would have gone would have been implemented this school year but because of covid we delayed it and so that has given us you know a silver lining if you can think of it that way it's given us an additional opportunity to provide support to school divisions prior to the implementation of of the system, particularly thinking about the definitions that we're putting forth around the data collection in particular.

[00:56:03] - I wanna make sure, Ms. Holton, I saw your hand up and then I didn't see it up, or did you get your question answered before I move on to others? - I do have a question, but I wanna defer to the committee members first, so. - Gotcha, I was trying to go in the order of the hands, but we'll go to Dr. Durong.

[00:56:23] - Thank you, Chair Pexton. - My question is really more of a technical one. I'm not sure who could answer it in terms of next steps and I'm speaking just as myself, one board member, but I think that when we look at ESSA requirements and there is the requirement that there's at least one non-academic indicator that we would use for accreditation and discipline is certainly one that four states that you described are doing.

[00:56:50] I think that discipline disproportionality and again, just speaking for myself, is a much better non-academic indicator gather the information we're trying to gather from our school divisions to help our school divisions and classrooms improve around equity than the one we do have which is um chronic absenteeism and we heard that from many of our speakers in previous panels about chronic absenteeism and a concern with that being a an indicator and yes we want it's not saying that we don't support students being in school but again using the indicators in a way that i think will help us as a commonwealth so my technical question is i don't know if it's dr lane or if it's

[00:57:30] julie i'm not sure who if we were to consider and i'm not saying we are because i'm just one person advocating for this but if we were to consider that we would change our non-academic indicator from chronic absenteeism to discipline disproportionality what would be the process for approval from the usdoe and what would be the next steps that we would have to consider and i know also usdoe says at least one on academic indicator so we could potentially have just this as a second one but just curious about that process because everything you shared today first thank you was

[00:58:03] very compelling and for me reaffirming of what we need to do in terms of having this as an indicator i think this is exactly the type of information and the reason why we have standards of accreditation to allow us to hold all of us accountable from those of us on the board leadership all the way

down to the classroom around what we've espoused and we've espoused equity and cultural competence and supporting students in the classroom regardless of race gender a variety of other things but yet if our accreditation does not match what we're speaking to then sometimes it's received as it's

[00:58:43] just talk and we're not walking the walk around that so i find this to be very exciting and i And I thank you for sharing it in the way you did, because I think it helps frame what I think this committee was all about, was to find areas and ways that we can best ensure that we're accomplishing what we've set out to do in the Commonwealth.

[00:59:01] And we again heard from many stakeholders who came for us, Dr. Pexton organized a very great panel previously, and they spoke about the non-academic indicator as not being meaningful or in some cases, you know, just an area that they don't feel is helping them overall.

[00:59:18] This I think will help us move there. So again, I'm speaking as one person, so I know we have a lot more discussion amongst the board, but I don't know the next steps about the logistical component of if we were to change and what that would look like. - Thanks, I'll answer that question, Dr. Paxton, if you'd like.

[00:59:36] And I'll actually defer to Julie, who's our resident expert on amendments to our application to go through the techniques of that with you. But certainly it would be a matter of amending our application. I think I would recommend to you that you not adopt more than one indicator, just because the process that you have to go through to change it ever again.

[00:59:59] But you can always add factors to your accreditation indicators without having to go through the federal government. But Julie, if you want to talk through the amendment process. Jennifer L. Thank you, Dr. Yes, that's my line of thinking. We can always take a look at our standards of accreditation as the state model and make changes without the US Department of Ed input.

[01:00:24] Jennifer L. However, if we do want to change our federal model and include that, then it would require an amendment. Jennifer L. And this would be a part of a school quality student success indicator. Now there are requirements of indicators to be a school quality and student success indicator.

[01:00:41] And one of them is the ability to dis-aggregate amongst student groups. So as a school's overall disproportionality rating, that is not necessarily, it's more of a characteristic of the school.

[01:00:56] So it would have to be researched. So that is a very different process. But as Dr. Lane rightly mentioned, our standards of accreditation is controlled by this board and could be modified in a much more simple manner.

[01:01:13] to to follow up your recommendation dr lane and julie would be to really not go through the non-academic indicator process at the federal but to to us to consider at the state i mean help me understand what yeah what i was saying is i i would not adopt more than one i mean you could choose one and we could probably create a factor with discipline that allowed disaggregated data it may not be this exact uh ratio that jen jen referenced uh but i i would only choose one so you're not having to go back to them constantly on that one. But should you be comfortable keeping

[01:01:49] both, which it sounds like you may be, then I would keep the one that you have and then edit it in the accreditation system. But should you want to only have one and it be disciplined, you can do that. Well, I'll clarify speaking for myself. And then I love Dr. Pexton. I don't know when the right time is for all

of us as board members and my colleagues to share. And I would advocate having just the one and it being disproportionality undisciplined that's what i would think is the best path forward but i i hope dr peckson we can have that discussion at some point because i think this is a very very potential positive step that we could take for

[01:02:26] thank you no other questions yeah i'll uh i'll go ahead and offer my thought process there as far as recommendations you know once we really came through all the presentations once we've validated and we've kind of reviewed what if we what if we what if we reviewed what if we just discussed uh really just actually just communicated with uh emily that i would want an aggregate list of what were all the recommendations that were brought before the committee and the board um share those with the board members so you can see them in one collective uh review you know and and sit on it for a while think about it a little bit and then come back and we'll have a discussion

[01:03:03] about really what we felt like were if if if there were items it sounds like there there will be but if there were items which ones would we prioritize that we would want to bring before the board for for consideration so that was kind of my plan as far as how we would kind of go back and really absorb all this information that we've been been so fortunate to to um to learn from the department of education thank you dr peck forward to that conversation um about this further then thank you

[01:03:30] Yes. And Dr. Paxton, before you go to other questions, I would if the board is thinking about changing this indicator or eliminating the chronic absenteeism indicator, it might be good to do a review of why the board did that in the first place. There was some really intentional work around having an input to the system and not and not just an outcome.

[01:03:50] And I would say that prior to COVID, the methodology, and I wasn't here when the board adopted it, but part of the board's thinking was that if we addressed inputs that it would change outcomes. And that was happening, that was working, and chronic absenteeism was having an impact.

[01:04:08] Now, I know school divisions didn't like it, but it's important for you probably to review how that came to be in the first place.

[01:04:20] Yeah, I certainly agree with that. And again, I think in my mind, the way that this could potentially work is, you know, really when we understand what all the recommendations are opposite of, well, what other impacts might these recommendations have on other items that are in our SOAs, at that point is when we would determine what's the best path forward as far as maybe getting some more education, to your point, Dr. Lane, to really understand if we're making the right recommendations and what are the impacts of those or consequences of those recommendations.

[01:04:58] And that's not to say we shouldn't add discipline. Sure. That's more a thought around, you know, I would almost have both conversations separately. Do you want to add discipline? Do you want to keep chronic absenteeism? If you want to keep chronic absenteeism, then we can set the federal government to the side and just focus on the state side.

[01:05:16] If you want to get rid of chronic absenteeism, then we should focus on the federal and the state side. Agreed. Understood. Thank you. Mr. Swan. Yes. So thank you, Dr. Pexton.

[01:05:32] So my question is, if we accept the discipline disproportionality for accreditation, is it saying that the greater the disproportionality, the worse the accreditation and vice versa?

[01:05:52] Mr. Swan, will you ask that one more time? I just want to make sure I understood the question. If we accept the disproportionality for the SOA, is it saying, according to the schools, the greater the disproportionality, the worse the accreditation for the school, and the less the disproportionality, the greater the accreditation for the school?

[01:06:15] Is that what that's saying? I think it very well could say that. I think that when you get to the point that you decide if this is going to be a factor in accreditation, there are a number of ways that we could have it count. What the board has typically done in these areas is they've created a range where you would say this range of disproportionality would be a level one indicator, this range of disproportionality would be a level two, this level would be a level three, and then are certain things that happen based on how many level two or level three indicators a school

[01:06:52] division has and so it would probably be more range based uh if i had to guess but i think once we have a better sense of the board's interest in in this specific factor we can create some structures with you around uh what that might look like and how it might count in the model thank you miss holton so uh first just a quick follow-up to i'm not sure where mr swan was going with that but one thought you provoked for me Anthony is this is just a very complex area

[01:07:28] and so if we as you suggest were to penalize schools with respect to accreditation based on disproportionality you know god forbid anybody should game the system but if they could just start disciplining the white kids more you know it might not necessarily get you the outcome you wanted or the or the women more if they're gender girls more etc so um uh so that and that leads to my my major comment which is i think it's really uh terrific to see the department doing

[01:08:03] uh good work around collecting more data collecting more consistent data um and um and using it in a transparent way both to further research and to inform schools to help schools understand where they stand and to direct resources to help intervene with schools where necessary i i am i'm nervous about adding it into accreditation when it's such a confusing area and complex and new and i'm also and this this i am actually leading up to a question for

[01:08:40] the panel i'm also curious when we talk about new indicators sometimes new indicators are literally just piling on old indicators so what does this data tell us that would be any different from what we already know based on you know we already know that frankly students academic outcomes schools academic outcomes can be pretty well predicted by their poverty demographics if you take a school's poverty demographics and combined the what we know about teacher inexperience

[01:09:18] does it really predict anything does it tell us anything new to add this disproportionality data in so just looking at your chart on the disproportionality data in that you know you've highlighted it by counties not by schools i understand but would it would it identify any schools as challenging that would be different from the schools who are already identified as challenged for accreditation with the other existing indicators um and if not and i i i um i suggest that there may not be a you know that basically the same schools that have trouble on academics are the same schools that are going to have trouble on behavior because so much of it

[01:09:57] goes back to family issues and to the fact that we have given those schools so much we haven't given those schools adequate resources or other supports to be able to hire to attract and retain great teachers if you take the teacher demographics and the student demographics that's sort of dictating the results on all these different categories so you know what new does it really add and and i would love to

see that data at some point if we could you know if we used a discipline disproportionality metric would it really identify as needing intervention in each schools that were

[01:10:34] different from the ones we already know needed intervention sorry for my very long-winded way of saying that. I'd like to address that a little bit if I could, because SBAR doesn't just measure discipline disproportionality in terms of suspensions and expulsions, which is where we're used to looking at it. It will also measure the opportunities that we provide students to change their behavior. So we're measuring what behavioral interventions schools are using, what resources

[01:11:08] are they applying to help students change behavior and we've never to my knowledge never collected that kind of information i think it will inform us as practitioners as to what is working and it will also maybe highlight some areas where those resources are more needed where there aren't enough school counselors where there aren't enough programs for for addressing families it might even and inform Department of Social Services as to where families need more resources.

[01:11:40] So I'm a dreamer and a big thinker in those ways, but I hope that that's the kind of information that we can get out of this and that it won't just be what's their disproportionality in terms of suspensions and expulsions, but also what's their disproportionality in terms of access to resources.

[01:12:11] And with the transition to the new data system, we have to, you know, our data may change dramatically after the SBAR with some of the changes that Rebecca just noted. So we have to be aware to also speak to Mr. Swain's notes.

[01:12:31] We just we have to move forward in determining those metrics, as Dr. Lane said, in a careful manner and to really evaluate the impact. and if it is if it is just adding another layer to schools that have already been identified i think those are all great points that would need to be evaluated in a deep dive before um any true decisions might might need to be made thank you thank you kisha can i ask a question uh if the committee's done sure dr robertson did have his hand oh that's fine i just slightly

[01:13:10] raised i'll go and go to him if that's okay president okay and i'll be very very quick uh again a very compelling presentation thank you all and i really like dr pexton's suggestion uh that uh in a subsequent meeting or subsequent material that we have side by side a comparison i took that to mean to uh to share with us research which speaks to the academic outcomes that are affected or enhanced by programming in either of the two indicators that we're talking about. That will be very important for our conversation. I think that's

[01:13:48] what Ms. Holton was getting at as well. Thank you. Thank you. President Gecker. Yeah, I was just curious, what levers do we have to sort of drive the behavioral change we want to drive short of the accreditation model.

[01:14:08] You know, it's, to Ann's point, it's not clear that everything ought to be tied to accreditation. However, it is clear we want behavior on the ground to change. And it seems that the board's opportunities to change behavior are limited.

[01:14:23] I mean, you know, James was not here when we did the change to, you know, for chronic absenteeism. But one of the reasons we did that was that it was a way to get school divisions to focus on a portion of the population that frankly the accreditation model otherwise wouldn't get to right the kids who were so far down the system that uh they didn't believe there was any hope they'd get them over the

threshold so they just never counted you know let's say the bottom 20 percent and here if we want to drive behavioral change which is clear um you know as the committee

[01:15:00] or the staff you know talked about what other things we could do and i noticed the committee dealing with accreditation changes but uh you know honestly you know all the performance standards in the accreditation system were meant to drive changes in behavior too and frankly in 20 years it hasn't driven that much change right uh in terms of resource allocation does staff have any idea what else we could do here uh aside from publishing the statistics that might help

[01:15:30] incentivize jurisdictions to you know change how they train and how they operate um if i can uh just comment uh hi good afternoon everyone leah walker director of equity at the department and i just want to um weigh in a little bit on mr gecker's question uh and some of the other board members conversation and questions i think um one of the ways that we tend to think about school discipline disproportionality from an equity perspective is that it actually serves both as an input and an output in some ways. It does in fact measure access to learning opportunity,

[01:16:09] right, which we tend to think of more as an input. If students are excluded from instruction then they're not able to benefit, right, from the learning environment and then able to contribute to the academic achievement outcomes that ultimately we're all primarily concerned with.

[01:16:27] And so I think it's really important to kind of keep that context and framing in mind as we think about school discipline disproportionality that while we often think of it as an output it is in fact a measure of access to learning opportunity secondly what i'll say is that when we when we really look deeper into the data and we didn't do that um deep of a dive into the discussion today around discipline disproportionality what we know to be true is that the discipline disproportionality largely is impacted by subjective offenses. So typically where we're

[01:17:03] seeing the overexpension or overuse of suspension amongst Black and Brown students in the Commonwealth of Virginia are for those subjective offenses. If we don't begin to hold our school personnel accountable for the bias and other factors that contribute to that type of discipline dispensation we're not going to actually see any change in the system so we've been measuring and reporting school discipline disproportionality for many many many years and in fact in the last several years the department has placed an increased emphasis on the reporting and created greater transparency

[01:17:42] just in the fact that we now display the data right as proportion in a proportional way like the percentage of student population versus the percentage of student um suspensions represented That was a new way of reporting that data that was added a few years ago.

[01:18:00] We would like to say that that resulted in, right, some positive change amongst outcomes that we're seeing for students, but it's, in fact, it hasn't. What we are seeing is that discipline disproportionality has continued to rise in the state, despite all of our efforts and increased transparency and using the bully pulpit and sort of all of the other levers that are available to us as an SEA as education leaders across the state to advance the conversation and dialogue around the impact of school discipline disproportionality on access to learning opportunities for all students and so

[01:18:36] i wanted to just provide that comment and sort of framing around this conversation because i think it's really important that as we think about what is the appropriate use of our accountability system particularly if we think about it with that lens towards equity we have to really think about um as you said

mr gecker right and miss holton said what are we actually measuring and what is the behavior that we hope to change and i hope that as we think about this particular um uh mechanism it within our accountability system that we we're thinking about the behavior of adults

[01:19:14] that we're looking to drive change around and particularly making sure that schools have an incentivized incentivized reason to pay attention to the dispensation of discipline and how it is disproportionately impacting certain students opportunities to access learning and uh i'll just add mr gecker that you asked about specific levers in addition to the you know the outcomes uh in the accreditation model which certainly leah talked about why that's beneficial uh very well

[01:19:48] um you i i'm i'm brainstorming as you ask that question so this is not in any way an exhaustive list but you could create mandates around professional development in certain areas you could uh put mandates into the evaluation system uh as we go into phase three you could create specific regulations over some of these factors. And so there are other levers. And certainly the department has found that the accreditation model is a major lever. And so

[01:20:22] that's another one because it does drive so much behavior. Okay. I'm going to ask if there's any final questions before we move on to our next presentation. Okay. I'd like to thank Dr.

[01:20:44] private rena and miss canard miss kahila uh miss malik for just really providing a great presentation on some important information that certainly did exactly what we said was engaging and very um interactive with the border of large interest to the board um so we will move on to our our next presentation at this time um which was exploring virginia's diploma and graduation requirements So next up, we have Dr. Leslie Sale, the VDOE Director of Policy, who will walk us through her presentation about Virginia's diplomas and graduation requirements. And her presentation

[01:21:21] will help us better understand the board's authority, the evolution of graduation requirements, and possible changes to both graduation requirements and the consolidation of diploma types. So with that, Leslie, I will turn it over to you. Wonderful. Thank you so much. And it is wonderful to see everyone albeit virtually um and i will um apologize with the beautiful weather comes lawn care so some ambient noise in the background as as folks are getting outside and taking care of their yards but i will do my best to speak loudly and hopefully you guys can hear me

[01:21:58] and i hope you will let me know if that is not the case so in the last several months um the board both the board and the soe special committee have heard several presentations that have asked us to re-examine some of our expectations for Virginia public school students, specifically our high school students seeking to earn a diploma.

[01:22:17] So this presentation hopefully will begin us in our thinking about how we tie together these discussion threads and start to link some of the more concrete proposals we've had we've heard with implications for graduation requirements like the Virginia mathematics pathways initiative, with some more consideration still in a conceptual stage about how Virginia's graduation requirements might be revised to address opportunity and achievement gaps in the public school system so noting that some of this work is still abstract this presentation i think is aptly named because of its exploratory nature um so in that way the information we offer here

[01:22:52] today is not meant to be preconceived in how we do some of this work but it's really meant to serve as a basis for ongoing discussion as we flesh out those ideas and proposals so emily has carried us in

to the the next slide um which is helpful before we jump in and of course this is where my policy brain always tends to start us in a discussion i thought it would be helpful to revisit the board's operational space as it relates to the topic at hand so the general assembly has prescribed some specific skills and coursework they believe necessary for graduation but language in the code of virginia really empowers the board of education to determine

[01:23:32] and construct graduation and diploma requirements and as this group well knows these graduation requirements are set out by cohort and our standards of accreditation so emily next slide in addition to setting out graduation requirements themselves the standards of accreditation also give us insight into the vision behind and the purpose of establishing graduation requirements so the quote provided here is found in the philosophy goals and objective section of the soa and i'm actually just going to pause here for one second to to give the committee and the board

[01:24:09] members joining us a second to read this and i included this excerpt because i feel like it highlights in particular the core values and priorities of the board and its design of graduation requirements which as we all know really centers around the profile of a virginia graduate so it clearly emphasizes the five c's for us the critical thinking creative thinking communication collaboration and citizenship as an essential part of preparation for life beyond

[01:24:48] high school and it also recognizes that success after high school can mean any number of things and it really accounts for student agency in setting these types of personal goals so regardless of diploma type the expectation is that every student graduates equipped for such opportunities emily next slide please purpose of the presentation which i know it might seem as bit of a buried lead here that we're just now getting to the purpose of the presentation but i thought it was helpful to remind ourselves of the board's stated philosophy as well as its

[01:25:23] goals and objectives prior to thinking about how we advance them in this next phase of discussion so the topics that we plan to cover today will help us consider ways that the board can further commit to its philosophy goals and objectives which already acknowledge the individuality of student passion as well as student need and the many paths we might take to not just accommodate but support both of those things additionally our discussion aligns with how the board understands graduation requirements which is really a foundation for which from which students can grow but should not necessarily create a ceiling or be overly prescriptive for the ways in which a

[01:26:00] student can achieve so while some of the topics that we raised today may be considered kind of fundamental shifts in our thinking and approach i think one of the the key takeaways and important takeaways from the previous slide as well as this one is how these discussions we're having here today may fit into what the board has already established as priorities for its work next slide so to hone in a little bit more on the details of today's presentation as i noted in the beginning this is about connecting some of our previous discussions and really finding an opportunity or

[01:26:37] opportunities rather that exists at our key point of intersection here which as we kind of identified it is how and where graduation requirements can operate as a lever for equity. So first, we're going to start with one of our more conceptual discussions, which is the possibility of consolidating the standard and advanced studies diploma.

[01:26:57] And hopefully this discussion will allow us to think through how we maintain a rigorous academic foundation in a way that's really equitably serving the needs and aspirations of all of Virginia's

learners. And this discussion also responds to a recommendation from the African american superintendent's advisory council and addressing how we might employ graduation and diploma requirements to close opportunity and achievement gaps so and quickly just to acknowledge that this presentation is really only meant to to discuss the standard and advanced studies diploma as part of a consolidation effort but there is of course the third diploma option in virginia which

[01:27:34] is the applied studies diploma and of course this option we understand is an important piece of the puzzle and how we support post-secondary goals for all of our students but the applied That study diploma actually is also the subject of some department review and revision based on recommendations that came from the JLARC study on K-12 special education in Virginia.

[01:27:53] So over the next few days, you'll have another opportunity to hear from staff on more about more information and how that work is moving forward and forthcoming related to the feedback from the JLARC studies. And secondly, we will discuss this on kind of the more concrete side of the spectrum, Virginia Mathematics Pathways Initiative, which is really also congruent with the board's goals and objectives and how implementation of the BMPI will impact graduation requirements in ways that

[01:28:22] promote educational equity, specifically in math instruction. So next slide. So again, starting with our consolidation of diploma discussion, which again is in that conceptual space, I'm going to have us time travel a little bit to provide the context on how we landed with our current diploma structure in 2011 the board amended the standards of accreditation to sunset three of its diploma types which was the standard technical advanced technical and modified standard diploma options so this brought the total number of available diplomas from six to three and continues to be

[01:29:02] our diploma structure today and while the number of diploma options did not change during the 2017 2017 review of the standards of accreditation the board has still made several several substantive changes to graduation requirements most notably of them in terms of the number and award of verified credits so we've seen a reduction in the number of verified credits used for both standard and advanced studies diplomas and there was also additional options for how you earn verified credits so and the intent of these amendments in short was really to ensure that our diploma

[01:29:37] options were more flexible more meaningful and more relevant for student goals next slide in its discussions leading up to the 2017 revision the board also actually also heard a recommendation from videoe staff on the merger of the existing standard and advanced studies diploma into a consolidated or virginia diploma so as drafted here and i know the the font is pretty small so i will try to walk you through this a little bit in terms of how it's structured

[01:30:13] students would use their first two years of high school in general and core courses with course schedules that look largely similar for most students and then in the third and fourth years students would be able to take specific courses or focus courses allowing them individualized academic and career preparation according to their individual interests and post-secondary plans additionally students would earn five verified competencies one in each of the core courses and one in applied knowledge and skills and this latter competency would allow students to demonstrate mastery in the five c's as well as in an area that aligned with their individual academic and

[01:30:51] career plan so really in short the virginia diploma was designed to promote life readiness per the profile of a virginia graduate and create multiple pathways to graduation for those pursuing two or four year post-graduation programs or their career interests and i will just say again for the purposes of

our discussion today this is really only an example of how a consolidated diploma may be structured and not necessarily what one would look like today if the board or so a special committee decided to move forward but just a launching pad for our discussion as we continue

[01:31:28] to flesh out this idea and next slide oh you're already there perfect um so ultimately after that discussion the board did decide to maintain the standard and advanced studies diploma and of course incorporated those additional revisions to add those components of flexibility and student individualization but i just wanted to pause here so you guys can kind of revisit um and and reorient

[01:31:54] with the the diploma requirements that are currently in effect next slide so who is earning the standard and advanced studies diploma based on data that we have from our 2019 cohort um the graphic here shows the percentage of students that earn either diploma type by student group so in the black coloring there and in case you're not able to see the key is the percentage of each student group earning an advanced study diploma and the off-white is the percentage earning a standard

[01:32:33] diploma so even though the board's revisions to graduation requirements in 2017 again did offer meaningful solutions in terms of making sure students had additional supports and options and their pathway to either diploma there does continue to be a stark difference in which students we see earning which diploma and i'm actually just going to pause there for a second because i i think this um or that slide there is meaningful as you're kind of digesting the data and our

[01:33:04] graduation outcomes and emily i think you can probably hop to the next slide now so not only does the data in the previous slide demonstrate a persistent disparity in graduation outcomes but as we all well know a lot has occurred in the year since the 2017 soa revisions that signal the need for this discussion again in 2021 so both the board and the department have committed to and reinforced educational equity as a priority in its work and some of

[01:33:41] the examples that immediately come to mind for me are the board's comprehensive plan its soq prescriptions its statement on racial equity among a variety of others and with respect to the department's examples some of the ones that are recent and top of mind are our recently developed roadmap to equity and the ed equity audit tool and of course the ongoing work and initiatives of our office of equity and i will say as i was brainstorming examples it was it was difficult to synthesize the amount and quality and quantity of volume of work that's happened in this space since 2017 the general assembly has also heard legislation responding to the need

[01:34:20] for flexibility and the pathways to the advanced studies diploma in particular so the bill that's coming to mind during the 2020 session there was a bill passed that allowed certain students to substitute computer science courses for world language course credits when the substitution was determined appropriate in the students and individualized education plan so it was a very specific and narrow flexibility but again the reason for the legislation was based on a concern that some of the rigid requirements didn't allow students to pursue or leverage their academic

[01:34:53] strengths and therefore saw that as preventing them from accessing a certain diploma type and most recently ASAC recommended action on graduation requirements asking us to take into account the variety of course progressions and the multitude of course options available to students which were was really founded on concerns about access to rigor flexibility in course selection and application and then systemic issues related to course placement among others so with these things in mind a consolidated diploma may be worth considering as a continuation of this work

[01:35:30] and a lot of the the kind of evolution that's happened since since 2016 and then of course the finalization of the soa in 2017 and would be a response to a lot of stakeholder advocacy so at the bottom of the slide not only made the need exist for us to revisit the conversation but trends in other states also indicate that a consolidated diploma is an is a viable one and 32 other state educational agencies actually have one standard diploma as well so this would

[01:36:00] considering this would bring us in line with national trends next slide emily so of course with any discussion of this magnitude there will of course be both opportunities and challenge so what do those look like in these cases um so and the information i will add on this slide is part of um or rather is based on some initial feedback that we receive from school counselors on the potential for a consolidated diploma and kind of imagining what new diploma structures might look like and among the opportunities that a consolidated diploma offer is promoting student

[01:36:38] engagement in courses that foster critical knowledge and skills areas supporting the ongoing implementation of the profile of the virginia graduate which sets shared expectations for students but also supports individual student goals and aspirations and employing creative means of awarding student achievement oh and then of course making diploma requirements a little bit more user-friendly ultimately allows for student empowerment and stronger supports from both staff and family. There are also several challenges identified which would require state and division

[01:37:14] level leadership to make sure that we are ensuring that staff have the resources they need to align course options with student goals and that divisions are well equipped to maximize course offerings to that end. Additionally, staff will need to keep top of mind the ways in which a a consolidated diploma can award and encourage student achievements so however in identifying these challenges at this early stage staff is of course better equipped to address these challenges and questions and its forthcoming work next slide emily so at this point um i'm going to transition

[01:37:54] us from a more conceptual discussion on the consolidated diploma to a more concrete proposal for which work is already underway and and the board and special committee are already familiar with so i do want to preface this slide um just noting that this is a little outside of my area expertise so i am doing my best to be a good steward of all of the incredible work that's happened on michael bowling's team and a linchpin of that being work from tina mazikane so and just a quick reminder on the premise of the virginia mathematics pathways initiatives um and hopefully not an oversimplification but vmpi is a really a proposed and a shift in the structure and sequence

[01:38:33] of math coursework for Virginia public school students. So whereas a typical math pathway generally includes Algebra 1, Geometry, Algebra 2, and possibly an additional course depending on the diploma type, VMPI would change the timeline and delivery of mathematics courseworks to include a series of courses with more integrated instruction throughout middle and the early years of high school, which build foundational and essential skills. Then in the later years of high school students would take advanced coursework tailored to student interests and aspirations so as that relates to graduation requirements in our presentation here today

[01:39:11] the virginia mathematics pathways initiative will create that common expectation that all students earn four credits of high school mathematics but allows for multiple pathways building from essential concepts to courses that are student selected based on career plans and personal interests and in this shift the vmpi pathways provide opportunities for all students to truly engage in deeper learning and

foster mathematical knowledge and skills and ways that are applicable to their post-secondary aspirations and so the reason for including vmpi as part of this presentation is first and the more obvious for the impact that we know it will have on graduation

[01:39:50] requirements and the work of the soa special committee but also among the goals of vmpi is to to improve equity and mathematics learning opportunities. So similar in spirit to the consolidated diploma, VMPI continues us in our thinking about how to ensure foundational knowledge and skills while promoting individual student pathways to graduation and then success thereafter.

[01:40:14] Next slide. So our next steps, and as I noted earlier, we are still in the early phases of some of this conceptual work and therefore still have a to-do list in terms of our due diligence here.

[01:40:31] In vetting the concept of a consolidated diploma, staff has already begun outreach and continues outreach to a range of stakeholders that will each bring a unique lens on how such a diploma might be constructed. Stakeholders that we will be spending more time with in the coming weeks include institutions of higher education, our special education community, high school and division administrators, as well as parents and family. Also in next steps, based on our ongoing discussions with the board staff is also working on the details of bmpi implementation namely how

[01:41:06] changes to math core structure will be incorporated into the soa and while this work and presentation is preliminary in some ways um staff wanted to be very intentional in its timing for engaging the soa special committee and the board so that our ongoing work was responsive to questions or concerns raised here next slide emily i will share that although the presentation's focus today was on

[01:41:43] those kind of two big puzzle pieces um the consolidate the potential of a consolidated diploma and the virginia mathematics pathways initiatives staff is also still actively vetting a number of other considerations that will have may have implications for graduation requirements among them the new definition and data collection related to students with limited and or interrupted formal education may require we revisit not just at accreditation indicators as is required by the bill but graduation requirements we may think about adding diploma seals and or specializations

[01:42:18] that recognize a range of student achievement in a way that we haven't before there's also interest in exploring ways that we support transfer students one and adjusting the number of verified credits that those students need depending on when they transfer into a virginia public school and allowing assessments that are currently unavailable to be used for verified credits once they transfer in and just for situational awareness and for the purpose of the soa special committee work there will of course be some technical and substantive changes to the soa as part of the implementation of vp vmpi and we expect that that some of that work might look like a transition

[01:42:55] cohort to allow for that change in graduation requirements depending on when a student is first taking algebra one and then of course a new graduation cohort based on the full implementation of vmpi additional supports to divisions to help navigate course planning particularly in the in the middle school and transition years.

[01:43:16] And then we will transition from algebra to the, the algebra one end of course assessment to essential mathematics concept one as a verified credit. And while the SOA itself doesn't detail or specify the types of courts, end of course assessments used for verified credit, that would be kind of part of the

larger wraparound, you know, system of implementation as we move forward on some of these changes to graduation requirements.

[01:43:44] So next slide. And with that, I will just transition us into the discussion section by quickly reiterating that I hope this presentation was helpful in imagining how some of the discussions intersect around the board's philosophy, goal, and objectives and inspire additional discussion and thoughts about how we might continue this work.

[01:44:06] - Great, thank you, Dr. Sale. Appreciate that presentation. I do have an initial question. You answered part of it towards the end 'cause I was going to ask as far as inputs from post-secondary institutions and, you know, perception of do the, you know, is there any history that has shown that advanced diploma students had a competitive edge just because that word, you know, happened to be on their resume.

[01:44:32] So I'm anticipating that's kind of some of the, some of the type of feedback you'll be looking to get from those institutions. But relative to the state educational agencies and the fact that there's so many, 32, I think it was, that are just using the one type of diploma.

[01:44:50] Is there also some intention from your team to maybe reach out to some of those agencies and ask if they've seen any particular negative or unintended consequences of just having the one or just kind of the why behind so many or going to just the one?

[01:45:11] Is that part of the team's intent or do you already kind of have a good beat on that? - So we're kind of operating at this point from data that was made available through the education commission of the states that give a broader lay of the land. But no, I think that's actually an excellent suggestion for some of the ways we might continue to do our due diligence and do some targeted outreach to states that are already there or transitioning or have recently transitioned to one senior diploma to understand the kind of cost benefit analysis that they did in considering the change and transition.

[01:45:45] So I'm writing it down on our to-do list we speak great thank you uh comments questions from other members of the committee and our board dr robertson yes thank you my again my question or comment is very brief the um the use of the word endorsed diplomas um and pardon me if this is this is something that's very clear to the rest of the committee or the board um i'm aware of diploma seals and and specializations but in

[01:46:22] reporting of states that have a single diploma with endorsements can you just briefly describe what you understand the endorsements sure and my understanding having been a few days removed from revisiting the education commissions of the state um states data in that space it would be just that very similar to what you explained that that would be um kind of the equivalent of a specialization area um or not necessarily a diploma seal but um kind of subsets of of specializations i guess

[01:46:59] that's probably the most appropriate word for um for that standard diploma um and i michael bowling has also popped on who helped me do the synthesis work for that data um and may have some additional context that would be useful yeah thanks leslie and and you absolutely spoke to it very well as well as dr robertson uh uh it quite honestly uh it indicates a specialty area maybe in the performing arts maybe in uh maybe in cte maybe in some states use career readiness as another measure uh and so um it kind of dovetails with our approach through doing diploma seals

[01:47:34] so there will be more discussions about seals in addition to uh you know how how we move forward with uh graduation requirements thanks thank you try that again off of mute mr swan thank you dr peckson um my question is does the virginia mathematics pathways initiative is that included in this consolidated diploma or is that something totally different well and and i will share that

[01:48:12] the consolidated diploma um you know we we provided an example of what that looks like in 2016 which did have four credits of mathematics incorporated um but that's not necessarily what that would have to look like this time although the virginia mathematics pathways initiative um would be a transition to four for high school course credits of mathematics um so in that particular regard i think it would be in alignment with what the the 2016 proposal had laid out um but that is not necessarily what we are proposing as a consolidated diploma moving forward um it was just exemplary of what they have explored in years past.

[01:48:47] But in that limited sense, I think it would look very similar to the 2016 proposal, just because it is that transition to ensuring all students get the four high school years of mathematics. - Thank you.

[01:49:07] - Other questions or comments? - I may? - Yes, thank you. So this is really a hugely helpful presentation. If I understand correctly, yeah, if we adopt the recommendations of the Math Pathways Initiative, we would need to increase from three to four the number of required math courses for the current standard diploma recipients.

[01:49:38] But beyond that, it would be up to us whether to, if we wanted to merge the two, whether to increase the requirements from the current standard diplomas or decrease the requirements from the current advanced diplomas, or some mix of the two, if I understand that correctly.

[01:49:56] And if I'm right, am I correct that the real difference right now is there are maybe five required credits for the advanced, they're now both the same on verified credits.

[01:50:12] So on the non-verified credits, the advanced diploma students have to take maybe five extra courses and one fewer elective course. So net four more courses. So if we added the math in, then we would be bringing the standard one up, but whether we would add other course requirements for a standard diploma or not would be up to us.

[01:50:36] And how we answered those questions about the math initiative and or adding other courses, what would be the potential impact on graduation rates?

[01:50:53] - Well, and I, so just to clarify that your understanding of kind of how that would all come together is correct. So if we start with the standard diploma as kind of a baseline for where we're making adjustments, understanding that the implementation of the Virginia mathematics pathways is already moving forward, that is already an increase by one standard unit of credit for the standard to get to those total of four.

[01:51:16] But then that leaves the three remaining in balance to find an equilibrium between a standard in advance for a consolidated diploma. Anything that I would comment on in the graduation outcome space would be speculative at this point, but I think it would be, that gives us helpful direction on some things to dig in moving forward, is evaluating kind of what those tinkering decisions would do in terms of graduation outcomes and impacts.

[01:51:43] So you would have a very clear sense of what we might see as outcomes and changes based on that. - So, I mean, even for instance on the math course, I mean, I think the impetus behind the Math Pathways Initiative makes a lot of sense. You know, these students who go one or more years with no math classes and then go off to community college or four-year schools and haven't seen a math course in too long, I think it's a really good impetus.

[01:52:09] But just to be clear, if we add an extra math requirement and if we possibly add other requirements to what are the current requirements for standard diplomas, it means some students who are just barely scraping by now have got to reach a higher bar before they graduate.

[01:52:26] So, and I think that those are students who we would serve them well by pushing them to add a little more, for instance, the math class, but every more thing we push them to add could potentially be one more thing that could keep them from graduating.

[01:52:44] And that hence my question. - Well, and I think some of the balancing component of a consolidated diploma would be, again, if we kind of think about it in terms of some of the core instruction and courses that we would want students to stay engaged in through the high school years, but then adding the flexibility that the hope would be that students are finding things that they're interested in that leverage their academic strengths.

[01:53:09] So the diploma is so well-structured to support them getting to the finish line. It just looks a little bit differently than how it's structured now. So, yes, for instance, even in math, it doesn't mean everybody has to take calculus, but rather that some students might have math that's more supportive of something else they're interested in.

[01:53:30] Precisely. Okay. All right. Ms. Davis-Vaugh. This might be an oversimplification, but building off of what Ms. Sulton was just saying, So if we increase a verified credit by one, am I understanding correctly that that means that's one less elective that students will have to be able to choose from?

[01:54:02] - And so for the increase in the Virginia mathematics pathways, as it gets implemented into graduation requirements for the situation requirements for the standard diploma, it would be the increase from three to four in the mathematics discipline area. Because we're still in the preliminary phases thank you for implementation there, there is still space for discussion about how that would impact the remainder of the diploma. And so whether we would see, you know, a decrease in an elected course, or maybe there's an increase in standard units of credit for the standard diploma altogether without additional mathematics course. But it's because we're in the preliminary phases of

[01:54:41] implementation there. I think that's one of the questions that, you know, that we'll be answering As we think about how that gets incorporated into the standards of accreditation and the existing diploma structure or a new diploma structure, depending on, on, you know, next steps. This is David's fault, I would note that this would not be an increase in verified credits, this would be an increase on the math on the math side on this standard units of credit so.

[01:55:08] The verified credits, as we currently are thinking of it, would remain the same five for both, which is currently standard and advanced so that would remain the same. Thank you. I have it now. Thanks. Commissioner Swann.

[01:55:27] Thank you, Dr. Peckson. I just have some concerns as a as a teacher with increasing the the math, even from tutoring high school students. I believe that we should push students.

[01:55:44] However, there are just some students who absolutely hate math. And so, you know, I've tutored high school students and after they finished that third math course, barely scraping by, they're just glad to get it over with.

[01:56:03] So if you increase or if you give them another math course, I agree with what Ann was saying, you know, it would change the mindset. And I do believe that we should push students, but I just feel like that, you know, you just have those students who hate math, even teaching fifth grade math.

[01:56:27] I literally had a student to say, I wish that I could murder the person who created math. So that's just my concern as a classroom teacher. - And I appreciate you sharing that, Mr. Swan.

[01:56:46] And I know the mathematics team has been very intentional to recognize that math may not be a passion of every student, but it has important implications and application for whatever a student wants to do beyond high school and really making sure that they're set up for success in that way.

[01:57:03] And so again, as I mentioned with Ms. Holtons question, I think it's striking the balance between ensuring that those students are given the opportunity to build foundational and essential skills, but recognizing that not all students might have same aspirations or the same passions for after high school um finding out ways that math can be taught and and applied and in applicable ways um that might that might inspire some some different attitudes towards math and math instruction and math learning um and i of course will we'll defer to michael i know their team has done just a ton of work um and how they you know that would be

[01:57:40] structured and how they could support students and moving shifting to the virginia mathematics pathways initiative yeah i i i do would like to respond just a little bit to that because as a former director of mathematics of the department of education and also now the assistant superintendent working with tina mazikane has been a real pleasure and one of the real reasons that we are implementing the mathematics mathematics pathways initiative is to help shift and change how students think about mathematics in general and so the focus is not necessarily on memorization and moving through content quickly it's about differentiating and

[01:58:19] getting to critical thinking skills and really going deeper into the the mathematical content content and and helping them think through things and how it applies to their world and so the the overall goal in the in the board heard a presentation about this uh in january and actually uh did vote on the timeline uh to implement the math pathways initiative and uh I do think it's very supportive of students' futures in mathematics.

[01:58:46] Thanks. - Thank you. - I just wanted to just add to that, you know, the Virginia Mathematics Pathway Initiative, it's equity work, right? And it's really framing and restructuring the way we think about the progression of mathematics in a way that meets the needs of every student and every learner, and allows them to create a pathway forward through the stacking of mathematic skills that align to both their academic competencies

[01:59:23] and their longer range aspirations, whether that be pursuing college or going directly into the work floors or pursuing a trade or other type of post-secondary credential.

[01:59:39] And so I don't wanna lose sight of the equity implications around the Virginia Mathematics Pathway Initiative because I do think that it will be one of the most transformational things we can do in Virginia to advance equity and really instructional support to meet the needs of all learners.

[02:00:02] - Okay, any other comments or discussion? Great, I'd like to thank Dr. Sale and Mr. Bolling for providing this information presentation to us.

[02:00:19] As we wrap up the meeting, I know we're a little bit short on time, but what I would like to do is kind of, as we move forward with this committee's work and start to think about presenting some specific recommendations and revisions to the board this early fall, late summer, I would like to just briefly ask Emily in a second here like to briefly allow the committee the opportunity just to kind of see a review of all the topics that we've explored and learned more about.

[02:00:51] over the uh through a series of presentations panels inputs from the department and various stakeholders in the commonwealth and i apologize that i just sent this to emily uh during this presentation so she wasn't able to uh it wasn't originally provided as part of your pre-reads i'm preparing for today but it will be made available um in our board book i'm assuming um for you to digest later but uh we'll just what ultimately what i would like to do is to have an opportunity to uh allow the board to review this information um think back uh if you

[02:01:30] can i know we've got some new some new uh board members uh that maybe weren't that was not there when we at first were brainstorming hey what are the key tasks what are the key topics we want to go go go go uh learn more about uh all of those topics have been addressed in one form or fashion but um you know really look at this list and say is there anything else as a committee that we feel like we have not dug into enough and so uh you know if there are if there are some things that kind of stand out to you um i'm going to defer to emily and or president gecker if maybe we should

[02:02:07] uh make that a priority at the beginning of our june uh committee meeting to kind of get that feedback at the same time um maybe by then we'll have an initial draft of just what were the recommendations that were presented to the board not necessarily recommendations that the board should should adopt or anything like that and really just kind of uh reconcile that about reconcile that against whether or not we feel like we've we've we've done our due diligence and so um just with a couple of the minutes that we have left are there any um comments or thoughts from the committee or even the board as far as off the top of your head if you know there's

[02:02:47] something more we'd like to learn more about i gotta change my view here so i can see all of you guys dr peckson i can stop screen share if that would be helpful i'm good right now see any heads raise i think everybody's deep into reading the slide but uh uh so seeing no initial thoughts or comments i don't want to close the book on hey is there anything else um so i would like to uh ask

[02:03:25] the committee just to continue to consider you know consider what we've reviewed and if there's anything else um emily i guess could we offer maybe the committee um you know we have to be thoughtful about how we communicate could we offer maybe if there's a recommendation that they send it directly to you or directly to me or what would you advise absolutely i think um if there are any kind of glaring omissions that we um you know haven't really dug into over the last several months if you can please email dr pexton and myself that would be very helpful as she mentioned

[02:04:04] we are trying to wrap up the special committee's work over the next couple of months and bring recommendations to the full board but we certainly don't want to miss anything that somebody would like us to to dive into i will note that over the last couple of months we have created the presentation schedule and work plan based off of the november discussion that the special committee have and so we

have um i think checked every box there as it relates to things within the soa um but again if there's anything we're missing anything you'd like us to revisit we want to make

[02:04:40] sure that we have an opportunity to do that hopefully in june um so that we can then start bringing some very specific recommendations forward uh for the committee to to consider and to potentially vote on okay so with that i would like to when you really look at this list it's it It goes with saying, I'd like to thank Emily and Dr. Lane and the staff of the committee.

[02:05:08] When you really sit back and look at just the amount of effort that went into to really present to the committee and the board this amount of information, you kind of eat the elephant a little bit at a time over the months and you don't really realize how much has really been prepared so that we could be informed as a committee.

[02:05:29] So I just really wanna say thank you to the department for your support and also to all the stakeholders who weighed in and provided input, whether that was at the superintendent level or whether it was the various partnerships we have with different associations around the Commonwealth.

[02:05:48] So to wrap up today's meeting, I'd like to again, thank everybody for the robust discussions today. Our next meeting will be June 16th. And good news is that, or at least good news as far as I'm concerned, we do plan to meet back in person for this meeting.

[02:06:06] So while it's adhering, of course, to all social distancing and masking requirements, Emily and I will be connecting in the next few weeks to plan out our agenda based on today's discussion and any feedback we receive after this. But with that, I want to thank you all for your time and contributions.

[02:06:23] And there's still a little sunshine out there. So if you haven't mowed your grass yet, I think I'm going to go mow mine. So go enjoy the weather. So thanks, everybody. Have a good afternoon.

